

EU finalizes deal to share traveler data with US border forces

送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-09-10 22:58

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By Ellen O'Regan · Sep 10, 2026, 3:34 PM · [View in your browser](#)

The European Commission has brokered a deal with Washington that could pave the way for European Union and United States border forces to share data on travelers that “pose a serious and genuine risk to public security or public order,” it said Thursday.

The U.S. has set a deadline of the end of 2026 for countries to agree data sharing deals with its Department of Homeland Security, or else they risk being dropped from the program that allows their citizens to travel to the U.S. without a visa.

In December, EU capitals asked the Commission to negotiate a framework data sharing deal with Washington on their behalf. The framework will then guide negotiations between individual countries and the U.S., to form so-called Enhanced Border Security Partnerships.

The Commission confirmed it has finalized the text of a framework agreement for the partnerships and sent two proposals to countries in the Council of the EU to sign and conclude the framework.

The framework also needs to be signed off by lawmakers in the European Parliament.

The negotiations are progressing despite growing concerns about American surveillance. The Commission said that the framework agreement has “robust” data protection safeguards .

National-level negotiations on the individual EBSPs can only begin after the framework agreement has been formally concluded.

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